

HOW TO MAKE A FABULOUS FILTER

Making a water filter is just the first part of this experiment. You'll also be making your own dirty water to test it! The materials you need are not hard to get, but you might have to ask an adult to help you look for some of them. Even though the completed filter does a pretty good job, the water that passes through it still won't be safe enough to drink. So just pour it away afterward.



Time
25 minutes



Difficulty
Medium

WHAT YOU NEED



Charcoal



Spoon



Cotton balls



Scissors



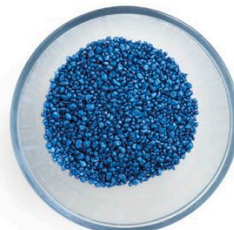
Sand



Small, clean pebbles



Leaves and grass



Small gravel



Soil



Medium sized gravel



Pitcher



Plastic bottle



1 First, cut all around the bottle with the scissors, just above halfway up. If you find this tricky, ask an adult to do it for you. The top part is going to be the filter. The bottom part makes a holder for the top and collects the water.



2 If your bottle has a cap, remove it. Tightly pack the cotton balls into the mouth of the bottle. These will trap very small pieces of dirt floating in the water.